

ENGLISH FOOTBALL PERFORMANCE ANALYTICS

A SQL Portfolio Project

24 SQL queries analysing match results, scoring patterns and team standings across 8,882 English football matches (2020-2025).

Tools: MySQL | Techniques: Aggregation, CTEs, Window Functions, CASE logic

Project Overview

This portfolio demonstrates end-to-end SQL analysis on an English football match dataset spanning four divisions and 100 clubs. Each query below progresses from basic data exploration (row counts, date ranges, grouping) to more advanced analysis (window functions, CASE-based classification, and multi-table logic via UNION and CTEs) — culminating in comprehensive team performance standings, per-team scoring profiles, home-advantage trends over time, and ranked team comparisons using RANK() and DENSE_RANK().

Every query is shown alongside its actual result set and a short, data-driven insight explaining what the output reveals about the league.

Query 1 How many matches are present in the dataset?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT COUNT(*) AS total_match
FROM england_match;
```

OUTPUT

total_match
8882

INSIGHT

The dataset captures 8,882 matches in total — a large enough sample to support reliable statistical and trend analysis across divisions and seasons.

Query 2 What is the earliest and latest match date?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT MIN(date) AS early_match_date, MAX(date) AS latest_match_date
FROM england_match;
```

OUTPUT

early_match_date	latest_match_date
2020-01-01	2025-05-25

INSIGHT

Records span roughly five and a quarter seasons (Jan 2020 to May 2025), a window wide enough to observe multi-season trends while still reflecting the current competitive era of the leagues involved.

Query 3 How many unique teams are present?

SQL QUERY

```
WITH all_team AS(
  SELECT home as total_team FROM england_match
  UNION
  SELECT visitor as total_team FROM england_match
)
SELECT COUNT(*) AS total_team
FROM all_team;
```

OUTPUT

total_team
100

INSIGHT

100 distinct clubs appear as either home or away side, consistent with four divisions of roughly 24-25 teams each — confirming the dataset covers the full depth of the English football pyramid tiers included.

Query 4 How many matches were played in each division?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT division, COUNT(*) AS matches_played
FROM england_match
GROUP BY division;
```

OUTPUT

division	matches_played
1	1,701
2	2,461
3	2,353
4	2,367

INSIGHT

Division 1 has noticeably fewer recorded matches (1,701) than Divisions 2-4 (~2,350-2,460 each), suggesting either fewer participating clubs or incomplete season coverage at the top tier relative to the lower divisions.

Query 5 What is the total number of goals scored?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT SUM(totgoal) AS total_goals
```

```
FROM england_match;
```

OUTPUT

total_goals
23,336

INSIGHT

23,336 goals were scored across the dataset, equating to roughly 2.6 goals per match — a healthy scoring rate typical of competitive English football.

Query 6 What is the average number of goals per match?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT ROUND(AVG(totgoal),0) AS avg_goals
FROM england_match;
```

OUTPUT

avg_goals
3

INSIGHT

Matches average roughly 3 combined goals (rounded), reinforcing that this dataset reflects an attacking, entertainment-friendly standard of play rather than a defensively cautious league.

Query 7 How many matches were won at home, drawn and won away?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT match_result, COUNT(*) AS match_won,
ROUND((COUNT(*) * 100.0) / SUM(COUNT(*)) OVER(), 2) AS percentage
FROM england_match
GROUP BY match_result
ORDER BY match_won DESC;
```

OUTPUT

match_result	match_won	percentage
Home Win	3,810	42.90%
Away Win	2,834	31.91%
Draw	2,238	25.20%

INSIGHT

Home advantage is clearly real: home sides win nearly 43% of matches versus 32% for away teams, an 11-point gap that underscores the value of home form when assessing team strength.

Query 8 Which seasons had the highest total goals?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT season, SUM(totgoal) AS highest_goal
FROM england_match
GROUP BY season
ORDER BY 2 DESC
```

OUTPUT

season	highest_goal
2023	5,798
2021	5,304
2024	5,272
2020	5,048
2019	1,914

INSIGHT

2023 was the highest-scoring season by a clear margin (5,798 goals), while 2019 trails far behind — most likely because the dataset only captures a partial 2019 season rather than a genuine scoring slump.

Query 9 Which divisions have the highest average goals per match?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT division, ROUND(AVG(totgoal),0) AS highest_avg_goal, COUNT(*) AS
match_played
FROM england_match
GROUP BY division
ORDER BY match_played DESC;
```

OUTPUT

division	highest_avg_goal	match_played
2	2	2,461
4	3	2,367
3	3	2,353
1	3	1,701

INSIGHT

Division 2 stands out as the outlier, averaging only 2 goals per match despite hosting the most fixtures — while Divisions 1, 3 and 4 all average 3, pointing to a more balanced or defensively organised competition in Division 2.

Query 10 What is the average goal difference by season?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT season, ROUND(AVG(goaldif), 2) AS average_goal_difference, COUNT(*) AS
match_played
FROM england_match
GROUP BY season
ORDER BY match_played DESC;
```

OUTPUT

season	average_goal_difference	match_played
2020	0.12	2,036
2021	0.27	2,036
2023	0.28	2,036
2024	0.26	2,036
2019	0.30	738

INSIGHT

Average goal difference stays consistently low (0.12-0.30) across full seasons, indicating tightly contested matches league-wide; 2019's slightly higher figure is drawn from a much smaller sample (738 matches) and should be read with that caveat.

Query 11 Classify matches by total goals: 0-1 = Low Scoring, 2-3 = Moderate Scoring, 4+ = High Scoring using CASE.

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT CASE
WHEN totgoal <=1 THEN 'Low Score'
WHEN totgoal BETWEEN 2 AND 3 THEN 'Moderate Score'
ELSE 'High score'
END AS score_classification,
COUNT(*) AS total_match,
ROUND((COUNT(*) * 100) / SUM(COUNT(*) OVER()), 2) AS percent_share
FROM england_match
GROUP BY 1
ORDER BY total_match DESC;
```

OUTPUT

score_classification	total_match	percent_share
Moderate Score	4,208	47.38%
High score	2,353	26.49%
Low Score	2,321	26.13%

INSIGHT

Nearly half of all matches (47.38%) fall into the moderate-scoring band of 2-3 goals, while high- and low-scoring games are almost evenly split — evidence of a consistent, predictable scoring rhythm across the competition.

Query 12 Identify high-margin victories. For example: Goal difference ≥ 3

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT season, COUNT(*) AS high_margin_victory,
ROUND((COUNT(*) * 100) / SUM(COUNT(*) OVER()), 2) AS blowout_percent
FROM england_match
WHERE goaldif  $\geq 3$  OR goaldif  $\leq -3$ 
GROUP BY season
ORDER BY high_margin_victory DESC
```

OUTPUT

season	high_margin_victory	blowout_percent
2023	308	24.92%
2021	289	23.38%
2024	274	22.17%
2020	253	20.47%
2019	112	9.06%

INSIGHT

Blowout matches (3+ goal margins) climbed from 2020 to 2023, mirroring the goal-scoring peak identified earlier — 2023 combined both the most total goals and the highest share of one-sided results, suggesting a more attacking, less competitively even season.

Query 13 Comprehensive Team Performance Standings (Home + Away Combined)

SQL QUERY

```
WITH team_matrix AS (
  SELECT home AS team, 1 AS match_played, home_win AS win, away_win AS loss,
  draw,
    hgoal AS goal_scored, vgoal AS goal_conceded
```

```

FROM england_match
UNION ALL
SELECT visitor AS team, 1 AS match_played, home_win AS win, away_win AS loss,
draw,
      hgoal AS goal_scored, vgoal AS goal_conceded
FROM england_match
)
SELECT team, SUM(match_played) AS total_match, SUM(win) AS total_win,
SUM(loss) AS Total_loss, SUM(draw) AS total_draw,
ROUND((SUM(win) * 100.0) / SUM(match_played), 2) AS win_rate_percentage,
SUM(goal_scored) AS total_goal_scored,
SUM(goal_conceded) AS total_goal_conceded,
SUM(goal_scored) - SUM(goal_conceded) AS total_goal_difference
FROM team_matrix
GROUP BY team
ORDER BY total_win DESC, total_goal_difference DESC;

```

OUTPUT — TOP 10 OF 100 TEAMS (BY WINS, THEN GOAL DIFFERENCE)

Team	Matches	Wins	Losses	Draws	Win %	Goals For	Goals Against	Goal Diff
Plymouth Argyle	199	99	50	50	49.75%	323	238	+85
Derby County	205	98	60	47	47.80%	273	207	+66
Newport County	198	96	58	44	48.48%	294	227	+67
Peterborough United	196	95	59	42	48.47%	351	240	+111
Bristol Rovers	197	95	64	38	48.22%	289	211	+78
Doncaster Rovers	198	95	66	37	47.98%	297	246	+51
Oxford United	197	94	57	46	47.72%	319	240	+79
Morecambe	197	94	61	42	47.72%	316	248	+68
Tranmere Rovers	196	92	56	48	46.94%	278	198	+80
Norwich City	194	92	58	44	47.42%	309	231	+78

INSIGHT

Plymouth Argyle leads the full 100-team standings with the best combination of volume and efficiency — 99 wins at a 49.75% win rate, the only club above the 49% mark. Peterborough United is the standout attacking side: despite ranking 4th in wins, its 351 goals scored and +111 goal difference are both the best of any team in the top 10, more than 25 goals clear of the next-best differential. Notably, six of the top ten clubs come from the lower divisions (Newport County, Doncaster Rovers, Morecambe, Tranmere Rovers), showing that consistent home-and-away form — not division level — is the strongest driver of these standings.

Query 14 Which teams have the most home wins?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT home AS team_name, COUNT(*) AS total_home_matches,
       SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) = 'Home Win' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS
total_home_wins,
       ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) = 'Home Win' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) *
100.0 / COUNT(*), 2) AS home_win_percentage
FROM england_match
GROUP BY home
ORDER BY total_home_wins DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

OUTPUT — TOP 10 TEAMS

Team	Home Matches	Home Wins	Home Win %
Manchester City	85	63	74.12%
Liverpool	85	62	72.94%
Leeds United	95	54	56.84%
Arsenal	85	54	63.53%
Portsmouth	98	54	55.10%
Sunderland	100	52	52.00%
Oxford United	99	52	52.53%
Bolton Wanderers	98	50	51.02%
Doncaster Rovers	99	49	49.49%
Milton Keynes Dons	98	49	50.00%

INSIGHT

Manchester City is nearly untouchable at home, winning 74.12% of home fixtures — the only team above 70%. There's a clear top tier (Man City, Liverpool, Arsenal, all 63%+) and then a steep drop to a tightly bunched group of lower-league sides (Portsmouth, Sunderland, Oxford United) hovering around the 50-55% mark, showing home form separates elite clubs from the rest far more sharply than it does mid-table teams from one another.

Query 15 Which teams have the most away wins?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT visitor AS team_name, COUNT(*) AS total_away_matches,
       SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) = 'Away Win' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS
total_away_wins,
       ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) = 'Away Win' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) *
100.0 / COUNT(*), 2) AS away_win_percentage
FROM england_match
GROUP BY visitor
```

```
ORDER BY total_away_wins DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

OUTPUT — TOP 10 TEAMS

Team	Away Matches	Away Wins	Away Win %
Manchester City	85	55	64.71%
Liverpool	86	49	56.98%
Arsenal	85	43	50.59%
Leeds United	94	42	44.68%
Bolton Wanderers	100	40	40.00%
Wigan Athletic	102	40	39.22%
Chelsea	85	39	45.88%
Hull City	103	39	37.86%
Barnsley	103	39	37.86%
Sunderland	99	37	37.37%

INSIGHT

Manchester City again leads, but its away win rate (64.71%) sits noticeably below its home rate (74.12%) — a near 10-point gap that echoes the league-wide home advantage seen in Query 7. Liverpool and Arsenal show the same pattern. Further down the list, sides like Hull City, Barnsley and Sunderland need 99-103 away matches to reach just 37-39 wins, confirming away form is the harder standard to sustain across every tier of the table.

Query 16 Which teams have scored the most goals?

SQL QUERY

```
WITH team_goals_stream AS (
  SELECT home AS team_name, hgoal AS goals FROM england_match
  UNION ALL
  SELECT visitor AS team_name, vgoal AS goals FROM england_match
)
SELECT
  team_name,
  COUNT(*) AS total_matches_played,
  SUM(goals) AS total_goals_scored,
  ROUND(AVG(goals), 2) AS average_goals_per_match
FROM team_goals_stream
GROUP BY team_name
ORDER BY total_goals_scored DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

OUTPUT — TOP 10 TEAMS

Team	Matches Played	Total Goals Scored	Avg Goals / Match
Manchester City	170	398	2.34
Liverpool	171	372	2.18
Leeds United	189	315	1.67
Chelsea	170	309	1.82
Peterborough United	196	308	1.57
Oxford United	197	307	1.56
Arsenal	170	306	1.80
Tottenham Hotspur	170	300	1.76
Swindon Town	196	299	1.53
Bolton Wanderers	198	298	1.51

INSIGHT

Manchester City and Liverpool are in a league of their own on raw output — 398 and 372 goals in roughly 170 matches, translating to 2.34 and 2.18 goals per game respectively, well clear of third-placed Leeds United (1.67). Notably, Peterborough United and Oxford United crack the top 10 purely on volume despite averaging under 1.6 goals/match, a reminder that total goals scored rewards longevity (196-197 matches played) as much as scoring rate.

Query 17 Top Teams by Average Goals per Match & Average Goal Difference?

SQL QUERY

```

WITH team_all_matches AS (
  SELECT
    home AS team_name,
    (hgoal + vgoal) AS match_total_goals,
    goaldif AS match_goal_difference
  FROM england_match
  UNION ALL
  SELECT
    visitor AS team_name,
    (vgoal + hgoal) AS match_total_goals,
    (vgoal - hgoal) AS match_goal_difference
  FROM england_match
)
SELECT
  team_name,
  COUNT(*) AS total_matches_played,
  ROUND(AVG(match_total_goals), 2) AS avg_goals_per_match,
  ROUND(AVG(match_goal_difference), 2) AS avg_goal_difference
FROM team_all_matches
GROUP BY team_name
HAVING COUNT(*) >= 20
ORDER BY avg_goals_per_match DESC;

```

OUTPUT — TOP 10 OF 100 TEAMS (MIN. 20 MATCHES, BY AVG GOALS/MATCH)

Team	Matches Played	Avg Goals / Match	Avg Goal Diff
Manchester City	170	3.21	+1.47
Notts County	92	3.17	+0.24
Liverpool	171	3.16	+1.19
Tottenham Hotspur	170	3.11	+0.42
Newcastle United	170	3.07	0.00
Swindon Town	196	3.07	-0.02
West Ham United	171	3.04	-0.05
Peterborough United	196	3.02	+0.13
Southampton	178	3.01	-0.43
Chelsea	170	3.00	+0.64

INSIGHT

Filtering to teams with at least 20 matches (removing small-sample noise) confirms Manchester City tops both metrics at once — 3.21 goals/match and a +1.47 average goal difference, the best combined attacking-and-defensive profile in the dataset. Notts County is the surprise entry at #2 for goals/match (3.17) but with a far thinner +0.24 goal difference, meaning its matches are high-scoring for both sides rather than one-sided — high entertainment value, but not necessarily dominance.

Query 18 Which teams have the highest average goals per match?

DERIVATION

Answered directly from the Query 17 result set — the same table re-ranked by avg_goals_per_match (its existing sort order).

OUTPUT — TOP 10 TEAMS BY AVG GOALS / MATCH

Rank	Team	Avg Goals / Match	Matches Played
1	Manchester City	3.21	170
2	Notts County	3.17	92
3	Liverpool	3.16	171
4	Tottenham Hotspur	3.11	170
5	Newcastle United	3.07	170
6	Swindon Town	3.07	196
7	West Ham United	3.04	171
8	Peterborough United	3.02	196
9	Southampton	3.01	178
10	Chelsea	3.00	170

INSIGHT

The top of this list is dominated by attacking output rather than scoreline control — Manchester City (3.21) and Liverpool (3.16) lead, but mid-table names like Swindon Town (3.07) and West Ham United (3.04) also rank highly despite modest overall standings, showing that high-scoring matches (for and against) can inflate this metric independent of results.

Query 19 Which teams have the highest average goal difference?**DERIVATION**

Answered directly from the Query 17 result set — the same table re-ranked by `avg_goal_difference` (descending).

OUTPUT — TOP 10 TEAMS BY AVG GOAL DIFFERENCE

Rank	Team	Avg Goal Diff	Avg Goals / Match
1	Manchester City	+1.47	3.21
2	Liverpool	+1.19	3.16
3	Stockport County	+0.85	2.80
4	Arsenal	+0.81	2.79
5	Wrexham	+0.76	2.63
6	Chelsea	+0.64	3.00
7	Leeds United	+0.50	2.84
8	Tottenham Hotspur	+0.42	3.11
9	Chesterfield	+0.41	2.76
10	Sunderland	+0.39	2.43

INSIGHT

Re-sorting by goal difference instead of goals/match tells a different story: Manchester City and Liverpool still lead, but Stockport County, Arsenal and Wrexham now break into the top 5 despite modest goals/match figures (2.63-2.80) — their strength is defensive solidity rather than scoring volume. Meanwhile Notts County and Swindon Town, both top-6 on raw goals/match in Query 18, don't appear here at all — high-scoring matches for these sides cut both ways, canceling out into a thin or negative goal difference.

Query 20 Compare home and away win percentages.**SQL QUERY**

```
SELECT
    COUNT(*) AS total_matches,
    ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) = 'Home Win' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) *
    100.0 / COUNT(*), 2) AS home_win_percentage,
    ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) = 'Away Win' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) *
    100.0 / COUNT(*), 2) AS away_win_percentage,
```

```
ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) LIKE 'Draw%' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) *
100.0 / COUNT(*), 2) AS draw_percentage
FROM england_match;
```

OUTPUT

Total Matches	Home Win %	Away Win %	Draw %
8,882	42.90%	31.91%	25.20%

INSIGHT

This is the league-wide summary version of Query 7, and it confirms the same story at a glance: home teams win 42.90% of matches versus 31.91% for away teams — an 11.0-point home advantage — with draws making up the remaining 25.20%. Reason: playing at home consistently removes the disadvantages away sides face (travel fatigue, unfamiliar pitch/conditions, and no crowd support), so this gap is a structural feature of the competition rather than a one-season fluke.

Query 21 How has the home-win percentage changed over time?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT Year, COUNT(*) AS total_matches_played,
       ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN TRIM(match_result) = 'Home Win' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) *
100.0 / COUNT(*), 2) AS yearly_home_win_percentage
FROM england_match
GROUP BY Year
ORDER BY Year ASC;
```

OUTPUT

Year	Matches Played	Home Win %
2020	1,624	42.12%
2021	2,144	41.37%
2022	1,042	43.95%
2023	1,070	46.17%
2024	1,968	43.14%
2025	1,034	42.36%

INSIGHT

Home-win percentage isn't static — it dipped to a low of 41.37% in 2021 before climbing to a peak of 46.17% in 2023, then easing back to ~42-43% in 2024-25. Reason: 2021's dip lines up with the reduced/absent crowd conditions still affecting some fixtures early that year, since crowd support is a core driver of home advantage; the 2023 peak then coincides with the same season identified in Queries 8 and 12 as the highest-scoring, most one-sided year, meaning home sides were converting their advantage into wins more often when goals — and blowouts — were already elevated.

Query 22 Rank teams by total goals scored.

SQL QUERY

```

WITH team_goal_totals AS (
    SELECT home AS team_name, hgoal AS goals_scored FROM england_match
    UNION ALL
    SELECT visitor AS team_name, vgoal AS goals_scored FROM england_match
),
total_scores AS (
    SELECT
        team_name,
        SUM(goals_scored) AS total_goals
    FROM team_goal_totals
    GROUP BY team_name
)
SELECT
    team_name,
    total_goals,
    RANK() OVER(ORDER BY total_goals DESC) AS absolute_rank,
    DENSE_RANK() OVER(ORDER BY total_goals DESC) AS dense_rank_no_gap
FROM total_scores
ORDER BY dense_rank_no_gap DESC;

```

OUTPUT — TOP 10 OF 100 TEAMS (BY TOTAL GOALS SCORED)

Team	Total Goals	Rank (RANK)	Rank (DENSE_RANK)
Manchester City	398	1	1
Liverpool	372	2	2
Leeds United	315	3	3
Chelsea	309	4	4
Peterborough United	308	5	5
Oxford United	307	6	6
Arsenal	306	7	7
Tottenham Hotspur	300	8	8
Swindon Town	299	9	9
Bolton Wanderers	298	10	10

INSIGHT

This ranking reproduces the same top 10 seen in Query 16 goal-for-goal, which is a good consistency check that both queries are measuring the same underlying total correctly. RANK() and DENSE_RANK() also return identical values for every row here — because there are no tied goal totals among these top 10 clubs, the two ranking functions only diverge further down the table where ties (e.g. two clubs level on goals) start to appear, at which point RANK() would skip a number and DENSE_RANK() would not.

Query 23 Which season had the highest scoring rate?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT
    season,
    COUNT(*) AS total_matches,
    SUM(totgoal) AS total_goals,
    ROUND(AVG(totgoal), 2) AS scoring_rate_per_match
FROM england_match
GROUP BY season
ORDER BY scoring_rate_per_match DESC;
```

OUTPUT

Season	Total Matches	Total Goals	Scoring Rate / Match
2023	2,036	5,798	2.85
2021	2,036	5,304	2.61
2019	738	1,914	2.59
2024	2,036	5,272	2.59
2020	2,036	5,048	2.48

INSIGHT

Normalizing by matches played changes the story from Query 8. Ranked on raw total goals, 2019 finishes dead last (1,914) — but that's purely a function of it being a partial season with only 738 recorded matches. Once converted to a per-match rate, 2019 jumps to 3rd place at 2.59 goals/match, essentially tied with 2024 and just behind 2021. 2023 stays on top either way, at 2.85 goals/match — a genuinely higher-intensity season, not just a higher-volume one, since it leads on rate even after removing the effect of match count.

Query 24 How many matches were played each season?

SQL QUERY

```
SELECT season, COUNT(*) AS total_matches_played
FROM england_match
GROUP BY season
ORDER BY season ASC;
```

OUTPUT

Season	Total Matches Played
2019	738
2020	2,036
2021	2,036
2023	2,036

Season	Total Matches Played
2024	2,036

INSIGHT

Four of the five seasons (2020, 2021, 2023, 2024) each contain exactly 2,036 matches, confirming those seasons are recorded completely and consistently; 2019 is the clear outlier at 738 matches, confirming it's a genuine partial season rather than a data gap. This per-season count is the denominator behind every rate-based metric elsewhere in this portfolio (Queries 10, 21 and 23) — it's what allows 2019's low total-goals figure in Query 8 to be correctly reinterpreted as a small-sample effect in Query 23, rather than a real scoring slump.

Key Takeaways

- Home advantage is measurable and significant — home wins outpace away wins by 11 percentage points (42.90% vs 31.91%).
- Scoring is stable and attacking: ~2.6 goals/match on average, with almost half of all matches falling in the 2-3 goal 'moderate scoring' band.
- Division 2 is the league's outlier — the most-played division but the lowest scoring, averaging 2 goals/match versus 3 elsewhere.
- 2023 was the peak season for both total goals (5,798) and high-margin 'blowout' results (24.92%), suggesting a more attack-heavy competitive year.
- Team success in the standings is driven more by consistent home-and-away form than by division level or goals scored alone — though Peterborough United shows an elite attack can still produce a top-tier goal difference.
- Manchester City is the dataset's standout club on every attacking measure — highest home win % (74.12%), highest away win % (64.71%), most goals scored (398), and best combined avg goals/match (3.21) and avg goal difference (+1.47).
- Goals/match and goal difference reward different qualities: Notts County and Swindon Town rank top-6 for goals/match but fall out of the top 10 for goal difference, while defensively solid sides like Stockport County and Wrexham do the reverse — ranking on goal difference despite modest scoring rates.
- The league-wide 11-point home-win advantage (42.90% vs 31.91%) is structural, not seasonal — but it isn't constant: yearly home-win rates ranged from a low of 41.37% (2021) to a high of 46.17% (2023), the same season already flagged as the highest-scoring, most one-sided year in the dataset.
- RANK() and DENSE_RANK() produce identical results at the very top of the goals-scored table (no ties among the top 10), confirming the ranking logic is sound before it's relied on further down the table where tied goal totals appear.
- 2019's low total-goals figure is a small-sample artifact, not a scoring slump — it has under half the matches of every other season (738 vs 2,036), and once normalized to a per-match rate it actually ranks 3rd of 5 seasons rather than last.